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Group Declaration

We, the undersigned, certify that the work included in this report is entirely original and was put together by the group members alone. Any ideas, text, or assistance generated using AI tools (including ChatGPT) were used only to support drafting, editing, and improving clarity. The authors, who take full responsibility for the final product, reviewed, corrected, and integrated all AI-assisted inputs.

Additionally, we confirm that each group member made an equal contribution to the project in terms of responsibility, effort, research, analysis, and discussion. No member was left out of any significant section of the task or made disproportionate contributions.

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Executive Summary

This strategic assessment offers a thorough five-stage consulting style analysis of ABP Ireland, one of the biggest beef processors in Ireland, with an emphasis on how the firm generates, captures, and maintains value in a quickly changing agribusiness environment. It concludes with a set of evidence-based recommendations intended to enhance sustained competitive advantage.

ABP's operating context is shaped by a number of important strategic concerns that are identified during the orientation stage. These include shifting consumer tastes toward plant-based and low-carbon food choices, growing sustainability obligations under national climate regulations, and the EU Green Deal. In the diagnostic stage, PESTEL, SWOT, and VRIO assessments show that ABP has significant advantages in the market, including scale, vertical integration, and the capacity to export internationally.

To ensure that ABP follows a distinct differentiation strategy based on premium quality, traceability, sustainability, and innovation, the intervention stage employs Porter's Generic Strategies. This approach is strengthened by important strategic decisions like strong vertical integration, dedication to environmental responsibility, and product diversity. Developing digital traceability, growing sustainable activities, diversifying into plant-based and high-end convenience items, and developing relationships with retailers and farmers are some of the measures that the report suggests to improve ABP's strategic fit.

Results from the evaluation stage show that ABP's sustainability pathway is strongly supported by regulatory demands, and the company's traceability measures are in line with the increasing demands for transparency from consumers. Nonetheless, ABP's dependency on beef emphasises the need for diversification to lower risk, and continuous development of supply chain integration and technology is necessary to preserve operational resilience. Prioritised efforts in sustainability, diversification, and integration are outlined in a five-year plan to enable long-term strategic execution.

Based on the report's overall findings, ABP Ireland is in a strong position because of its differentiation strategy, sustainability leadership, and vertically integrated approach. Future competitiveness, however, will rely on developing sustainability capabilities, broadening product offerings, reinforcing supply chain alliances, and proactively addressing shifting consumer and legal requirements.

Introduction

Anglo Beef Processors (ABP) was founded in Ireland in 1954. Today, they are the biggest beef processor in the UK & Ireland and operate across three complementary divisions: proteins, pet foods, and renewables.

As outlined in the executive summary, this report covers five key stages of the consulting process to assess ABP's current positioning and standing in the agri-business field. Subsequently, we will draw on this context and findings to develop our key recommendations for the future of the business in the intervention and evaluation stages.

Together, all components and findings compiled in this consulting process set out to provide an evidence-based analysis of ABP's strategic positioning and provide future recommendations with the support of extensively reviewed, reliable research.

Orientation

Identification of Key Strategic Issues

ABP Food Group ranks among the leading beef processors in Ireland and the UK, holding approximately 20-30% of the Irish beef-processing market. Its main competitors are Kepak (10-20%), Dawn Meats (5-15%). This share provides ABP with considerable negotiating strength, cost advantages, and pricing influence when dealing with large retailers. However, this also reveals competition as rivals are progressively enhancing quality, sustainability efforts, and export growth to surpass ABP's position.

The main strategic issue facing ABP revolves around sustainability regulations. With the EU Green Deal, Farm-to-Fork Strategy, and Ireland's Climate Action Plan, there are increasing goals for cutting emissions, optimising land use, and ensuring traceability. ABP has made progress through its circular economy projects and is cutting Scope 1 & 2 emissions. However, to preserve ABP's premium pricing and secure entry to export markets, ongoing investment in environmental efforts and supply verification is essential.

Another key factor seen is the changing tastes of consumers. While ABP has strong demand for grass-fed Irish beef, the long-term consumption pattern of consumers shows an increase in plant-based, flexitarian, and low-carbon food segments. ABP's reliance on beef means it is

slightly vulnerable to shifts in protein demand. The growth of its beef sectors, including pet food and renewable energy, is promising, but additional diversification into alternative proteins or hybrid products might be necessary to stay relevant moving forward.

Finally, ABP faces geopolitical and export dependence risks. Since more than half of Ireland's beef is exported, ABP would be exposed to regulatory divergence, post-Brexit global supply-chain shocks, and market access barriers. Strengthening resilience, exploring new markets, and differentiating through technology-including advanced traceability and processing systems, will therefore be important in keeping the business competitive.

Preliminary Literature Review

ABP's ability to generate value can be analysed with known strategic models. First being Barney's (1991) resource-based perspective shows why ABP's integrated supply system and strong reputation for premium grass-fed beef offer a competitive edge. These strengths are valuable and hard to replicate, meeting VRIO criteria and allowing for ongoing value retention. Porter's (1985) generic strategies further highlight ABP's approach by focusing on cost efficiency (through integration and scale) along with differentiation (quality, traceability, sustainability), allowing the company to charge premium prices while keeping operational effectiveness.

As mentioned, sustainability is a key element of ABP's value framework. The shared value idea put forward by Porter and Kramer (2011) states that environmental and social programs can boost competitiveness directly, of being just compliance expenses. ABP's circular economy initiatives, efforts to cut emissions, and investments in renewable energy follow this strategy. Furthermore, Hart's (1995) resource-based perspective believes that companies achieve sustained competitive advantage by developing competencies focused on pollution prevention and environmentally friendly technologies, an imperative aspect as ABP adapts to EU environmental policies and demands from retailers.

The rate of transformation in food systems further influences ABP's strategic environment. Reardon et al. (2019) highlight the need for flexibility as supply chains evolve, driven by changes in consumer behavior, globalization, and technological progress. This highlights the significance of ABP responding to trends like plant-based eating, digital traceability, and changes in export markets.

Nevertheless, ABP functions within supply networks influenced by governance criteria. Gereffi, Humphrey & Sturgeon (2005) state that companies situated in regulated global value chains gain improved negotiation leverage and entry to markets. ABP's cohesive model and solid alliances with key retailers position it, yet also increase vulnerability to regulatory inconsistencies and buyer concentration.

In summary, these frameworks clarify that ABP captures value through rare capabilities, sustainability leadership, agility, and strong global value-chain positioning, while also revealing weaknesses that require strategic attention.

Diagnostics

Macro-environment and Industry Analysis

ABP Ireland operates within a challenging macro-environment influenced by political, economic, social, technological, environmental, and legal pressures.

Politically, ABP is strongly influenced by CAP support, EU agricultural policy, and common traceability and food safety regulations. As a major exporter, ABP must also navigate post-Brexit divergence and the new EU Green Deal sustainability requirements, which increase compliance costs but encourage innovation in low-carbon production in the long run.

Economically, the agribusiness sector faces volatility in rising energy and labour costs, global beef prices, and exchange rate fluctuations, which can ultimately affect export competitiveness. However, Ireland's image and reputation for high-quality grass-fed beef reinforce ABP's opportunities to access premium markets in Europe and further international markets. Specifically, there seems to be growing demand in Asia and the Middle East for premium Irish beef, which welcomes new economic opportunities if inflation and cost pressures are mitigated.

Social trends progressively continue to form consumer expectations. Growing interest and demand for animal welfare, sustainability, and transparent sourcing put pressure on beef producers to showcase their responsible and ethical farming practices. Furthermore, the rise of various specific diets such as flexitarian, plant-based, vegetarian, or vegan, and the need

for meat alternatives, creates long-term demand uncertainty. ABP can respond to these pressures by enforcing strong traceability systems, Origin Green commitments, and implementing premium processes like their Ultra-Tender® (ABP, n.d.).

Recent technological developments offer significant advantages for ABP. Automation, digital supply-chain monitoring, and AI-driven carcass-grading can improve operational efficiency, enhance yield, and ensure consistent standards of quality. Technology also propels ABP's "More With Less" strategy by reducing waste and allowing for precise monitoring of energy, water, and emissions.

Environmental pressures influence ABP's strategic position in many ways. Firstly, Ireland's climate targets require lower agricultural emissions, improved biodiversity, and more structured resource use. ABP manages these factors through investments in renewable technologies, carbon reduction initiatives with farmers, and circular economy systems that convert waste into energy.

Legally, as previously mentioned, ABP must comply with strict EU animal welfare, labour, and environmental standards and must adhere to food safety regulations. These high compliance requirements may raise operational costs but also create strong barriers to entry, which can support ABP's competitiveness.

On a wider scale, industry dynamics are highly competitive. Rivalry among major meat processors like Kepak or Dawn Meats is intense, while retailers hold strong bargaining power due to price sensitivity, brand image, and traceability demands. Supplier power is moderate, and entry requirements remain high due to major regulatory, technological, and capital requirements. As a result, ABP’s strengths in scale, quality, and sustainability give it a clear advantage in navigating these competitive industry forces.

Internal Analysis

This internal analysis sets out to address key opportunities and threats that may be currently overlooked by the organisation, as well as what strengths and weaknesses it currently has.

To begin this assessment, a SWOT analysis will be conducted to give a holistic overview of the business's current standing.

Strengths: ABP strengths particularly relate to their vertical integration across all of their divisions (ABP, 2023), a high export capability/global presence (Food Business MEA, 2024), proven sustainable and traceable credentials across divisions (Circular Bioeconomy Cluster,) and of course being the largest beef processor in Ireland and the UK as well as in the top 3 in Europe (Irish Food and Drink, 2023), thus solidifying their dominance.

Weaknesses: One of the main weaknesses we identified was labour shortages in the processing sector, primarily amid competition from other sectors and increasing costs of living in rural areas (Farmers Journal, 2021).
High input and energy costs, price volatility in the beef supply chain, and limited transparency due to private business ownership were equally identified as weaknesses for the company.

Opportunities: Key opportunities that we identified for ABP were an expanding demand for beef globally, particularly in Asian markets (Global growth insights, 2025), premiumisation of grass-fed beef, technological innovation occurring with digital traceability and sustainability metrics, to name a few. Adding to this, we note that there is potential for acquisitions and strategic partnerships to further diversify away from relying solely on beef processes.

Threats: The first threat that we noted was related to trade and geopolitical uncertainty. Tariffs since Brexit have increased delays and costs for exports between the UK and the EU. Coupled with this, the EU's new trade deal with Mercosur has meant that there is a potential loss of 130 billion euros for the Irish Beef market. We also identified consumer shifting trends to alternative proteins, climate regulations, and environmental sustainability demands, and competitor innovation of lab-grown alternatives as pressing threats for ABP.

To further analyse the company internally, we developed a VRIO framework. This framework evaluates a firm's resources by asking if they are Valuable, Rare, Inimitable, and Organised to capture value, revealing which capabilities create sustained advantage.

ABP's analysis shows that its grass-fed, traceable beef and vertically integrated operations meet all four VRIO criteria, giving the group a *sustained competitive advantage*. Long-term

farmer partnerships and sustainability programmes are valuable but less rare, offering only a *temporary edge*. Meanwhile, assets like export capacity and innovation efforts provide *competitive parity*, and weak consumer-facing brand recognition delivers little strategic benefit.

VRIO Analysis for ABP Ireland

Resource / Capability	Valuable?	Rare?	Difficult to Imitate?	Organised to Exploit?	Competitive Implication
Grass-fed, traceable beef	✅	✅	✅	✅	Sustained competitive
Integrated operations (Beef →	✅	✅	✅	✅	Sustained competitive
Long-term farmer partnerships	✅	⚪	⚪	✅	Temporary advantage
Sustainability leadership (SBTi, circular economy)	✅	⚪	⚪	✅	Competitive parity / growing strength
Processing capacity & export	✅	⚪	❌	✅	Competitive parity
Brand recognition (B2B-heavy, low consumer awareness)	✅	❌	❌	✅	Competitive parity / limited advantage
Innovation & investment	✅	⚪	⚪	✅	Competitive parity

✅ =Yes ⚪ =Partially ❌ =No

Interventions

ABP Food Group's present strategic orientation is from the perspective of Porter's Generic Strategies Framework, which illustrates how corporations obtain competitive advantage through cost leadership, differentiation, or focus (Dewey, 2021). ABP's entire strategic approach represents a differentiation strategy that is anchored in the pursuit of superior quality, traceability, sustainability, and innovation across all parts of its operations. Rather than competing only on cost, ABP focuses on producing added value through its reputation for quality and ethical manufacturing standards, aligning with increasing consumer and retailer expectations for sustainable and responsible sourcing(ABP Ireland, 2024).

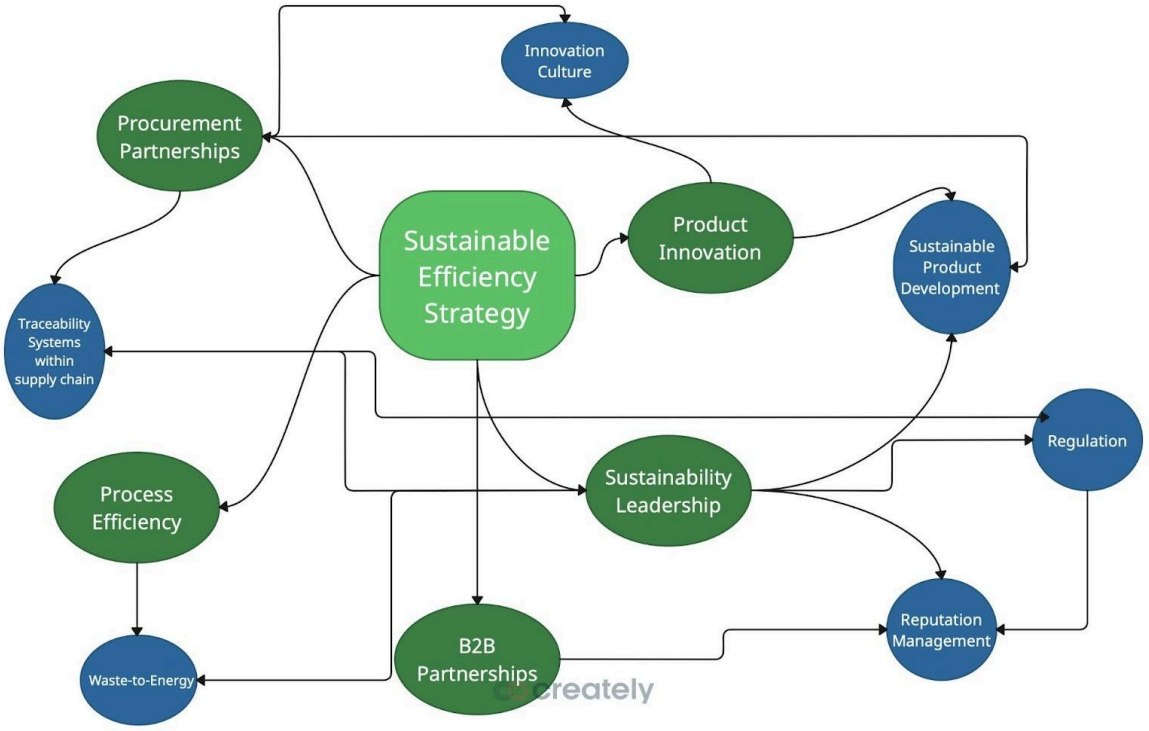
Vertical integration is a key strategic decision that supports this differentiation strategy (Arrow, 1975). From the purchase and processing of animals to packing and logistics, ABP oversees and controls every significant phase of its supply chain. This makes it possible for the business to uphold strict food safety and quality control standards, which are crucial in Ireland's export-driven agri-food sector. In addition to improving operational efficiency, vertical integration strengthens ABP's capacity to offer complete product traceability, which is a critical differentiator in a time when consumers are becoming more concerned about supply chain transparency and environmental impact.

A key component of ABP's business identity and long-term competitive advantage is its dedication to sustainability and environmental stewardship. The company's proactive involvement in lowering carbon emissions, preserving biodiversity, and enhancing animal welfare is demonstrated by its Sustainability scheme 2030 and initiatives like Blade Farming and participation in Ireland's national Origin Green sustainability scheme (ABP Ireland, 2025). These programmes have grown to be important differentiators, assisting ABP in establishing itself as a pioneer in the production of sustainable beef on a national and worldwide scale.

ABP has also taken thoughtful strategic decisions regarding product diversification and innovation. Through its cooperation with the Culina Group, the company continues to explore plant-based alternatives and invest in the creation of new products, including premium and convenience items (ABP Ireland, 2019). This kind of diversity shows how ABP can adjust to shifting consumer tastes and shifting market conditions.

The co-creation of high-value, sustainably sourced products that complement ABP's differentiation strategy is made possible by its strategic alliances with significant retailers and foodservice clients in Ireland and overseas. These partnerships improve ABP's long-term ties with important clients while reaffirming the company's dedication to sustainability and excellence. Collectively, these tactical decisions show a coherent and well-integrated differentiation approach that enables ABP Food Group to maintain its market leadership, build brand equity, and remain resilient in a demanding and dynamic global agri-food environment.

To explore the internal fit of how the proposed strategic choices of ABP Ireland will align, we must explore this using Porter's Activity System Map, which we have created below. The map proposed includes heavy emphasis on sustainability, integration, innovation, and efficiency across the organisation and its activities. Within ABP Ireland, we can see their vertical integration strategy and emphasis on cost efficiency.



The central theme that our consulting team has uncovered that is necessary for ABP's continued success is "Sustainability Leadership". As mentioned previously, the 2030 Sustainability Programme within ABP Ireland aims to aid the company in succeeding in its long-term environmental goals. This programme outlines clear, attainable landmarks for the company in relation to emissions reduction, energy efficiency, and waste minimisation. We believe that ABP Ireland can use sustainability as a strategic differentiator, making itself stand out from a social and environmental perspective to their prospective consumers. This is advantageous for companies as it can improve their own operations but also their relationships with customers (Porter & Kramer, 2007). Although sustainability isn't simply just a form of messaging. It shapes the operations and product development of a company as a whole.

Within the activity map, we can see "Procurement Partnerships". We believe these to be one of ABP Ireland's strongest strategic capabilities. Due to the emphasis we are placing on vertical integration, there is a reliance on long-term relationships with farmers across not only Ireland but also the UK to continue securing a consistent supply and traceability. ABP Ireland can leverage these strong relationships to implement their sustainability initiatives directly at the farm level, not only within their own facilities. For example, the Blade Farming programme, which promotes increased animal welfare and carbon measurements.

The strategic activity map visualises the interdependencies between each area. Such as procurement partnerships enabling enhanced traceability, which then supports sustainability leadership. This strategic activity map is not based on a reinventive strategy but instead enhances the pre-existing operations and capabilities of ABP Ireland. From a formal strategic planning perspective, this enhances the structure of ABP Ireland's strategy (Li, An, and Liu, 2021).

The proposed activity map demonstrates a strong strategic coherence among all levels of ABP's organisation. We believe that by implementing this strategy, ABP Ireland will be aptly positioned to implement these interventions organisation-wide.

Evaluations

Within the evaluation stage of this report, we will discuss how ABP Ireland's strategy continues and evolves, given the recommendations our team has proposed. Within our research, we have discovered the following four key areas:

Environmental Regulation:

From our research, we have identified increased regulatory pressure from multiple fronts. Notably, the EU Green Deal, specifically the Farm to Fork initiative, aims to accelerate the EU's transition to increased sustainability in the food network (European Commission, 2020). This increased pressure from regulators aligns with ABP Ireland's existing sustainability initiatives, such as the ABP 2030 roadmap. Through initiatives such as traceability and increased monitoring, ABP Ireland can advance their net-zero ambitions and comply with regulatory requirements. ABP's commitment to sustainability and environmental stewardship, a core part of the firm's identity, allows it to leverage future environmental regulation as a competitive advantage through proactively fostering sustainability against competing firms that may reactively invest in firm sustainability in response to legislation. Heavy investment in sustainability will also reduce risk by future-proofing the business against any future regulation.

Demand for Ethically Sourced Food:

Throughout our investigation, we have recognised strong growth in consumer demand for transparent, ethically sourced protein. This directly relates to environmental impacts and increased traceability in ABP Ireland's supply chain. As seen from the activity map, ABP Ireland aims to use traceability to reinforce their position on sustainability. By strengthening supply chain visibility to consumers, ABP Ireland can attract a wider plethora of potential customers, as seen in the previous PESTEL analysis.

Dependence on the Beef Sector:

During the diagnostics stage, we discovered that ABP Ireland has a significant reliance on beef revenues. This reliance can leave the organisation vulnerable to price volatility and, most notably, changing diet trends. ABP Ireland has been diversifying their portfolio by venturing into non-beef production and ethically sourced plant-based goods. By moving into plant-based proteins, ABP Ireland can respond to long-term shifts in consumer demand instead of short-term fluctuations in the beef market. Diversification is thus strategically

necessary and not optional due to recent price volatility. Not only will this allow ABP to target new consumers, but it will also spread risk throughout the organisation, ensuring the long-term resilience of the firm against further shifting customer tastes and trends.

Vertical Integration and Supplier Relationships:

Retailer pressure for transparency and limited traceability tool integration have been key challenges for ABP Ireland. Therefore, strengthening vertical integration is an imperative move to ensure resilience and control of the supply chain. By doing so, traceability and transparency will be achievable for ABP Ireland. By addressing these long-term vulnerabilities, ABP Ireland can maintain its competitive advantage. As a result, ABP Ireland will be able to achieve the goals of increased animal welfare and product integrity among their 35,000 supplier farmers, ensuring resilience for the long term. Additionally, there should be renewed energy in creating collaborative and innovative relationships with both current and potential distributor partners. Primarily, there should be an emphasis on coordinated marketing, data-sharing, and co-developed product lines to ensure store shelf dominance.

Taking into account these findings, presented below is a roadmap to change for the next five years of development within ABP Ireland.

Short Term (~1 year):

Sustainability - An immediate and thorough internal review into the state of sustainability within ABP Ireland should be undertaken, with particular focus on internal monitoring of potential threats to firm sustainability and measuring preparedness for eventual net-zero certification.

Diversification - Heavy consideration should be given to focused investment into plant-based alternatives in response to rapidly changing consumer tastes through either the creation of a new division or through the amalgamation of existing sustainability-focused divisions, both spreading risk throughout the organisation and providing the opportunity to penetrate additional untapped markets.

Integration - Outreach to current main distributors (Aldi, Tesco, etc.) should begin immediately to coordinate future cooperation and to align ESG goals. Preliminary outreach to

new potential partners, particularly abroad, should also be initiated, with sustainability and similar ESG goals being a defining filter for potential partners.

Medium Term (~2-4 years):

Sustainability - Following the completion of an internal review alongside the completion of any responses to potentially highlighted issues, third-party monitoring should be invited to encourage consistent and transparent sustainable transformation within the firm. Partnership with reputable, innovative firms focused on sustainable solutions should also be sought to account for any potential gaps in technical knowledge within ABP Ireland.

Diversification - Pilot production within the European Union of blended protein and plant-based products should begin in earnest, with coordination with partner distributors to ensure shelf dominance. Investment into developing a large advertising presence to present ABP Ireland as a pioneer of sustainable agribusiness should also be considered.

Integration - Alongside previously mentioned coordination regarding the launch of blended protein/plant-based products, focus should be given to coordinated marketing with distributors to both reduce wastage of capital and prevent conflicting messaging in advertising.

Long Term (~5 years):

Sustainability - Net-Zero Certification should be achieved through Bord Bia, providing a base for ABP Ireland to continue pioneering sustainable agri-business development, with previously mentioned sustainability-focused renewable divisions within ABP playing a key part in firm profitability.

Diversification - Newly developed blended protein and plant-based products should be expanded globally to emerging markets, such as Asia, North and South America, allowing for both geographical and product-based risk to be reduced.

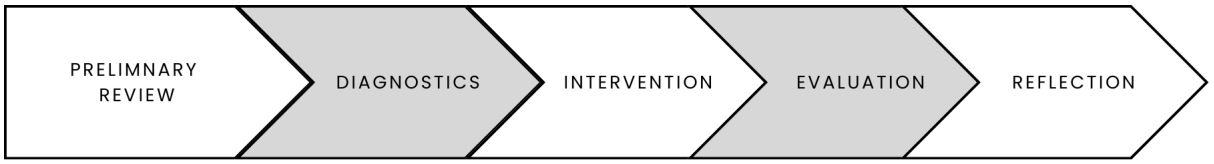
Integration - Integrated joint R&D with partner distributors should be pursued, providing both specialist knowledge and additional resources.

Consulting Process

Consulting Process/Team Reflections

To conclude this consultancy report on ABP Ireland, reflections from the team involved will be presented, alongside the key themes and lessons learned. Generally, all team members found that there was a clear link between the theory from lectures and the provided readings in this consultancy engagement. For example, VRIO, SWOT, and activity maps played a key role in carrying out both the industry and internal firm analysis presented in this report. Additionally, team members tended to enjoy the challenge associated with researching and familiarising themselves with a previously unfamiliar agribusiness sector and firm. There was also an appreciation for the challenge involved in creating a fresh and distinct, yet realistic future of ABP Ireland. As a team, we believe that we have performed above our own expectations, with our individual reflections attached in the appendices as Appendix I.

Consulting Process



The first stage of the consulting process was the orientation stage, which required us to engage in a preliminary review to establish a baseline understanding of the client and industry environment. Existing literature that was found aligned with ABP's key strategic issues, which helped identify how they could be combatted and related to the industry. These literature findings, along with our initial research of the company and its industry, gave us a strong foundation for how ABP captures value in its current market position.

After we completed this preliminary orientation stage, diagnostics followed. We first performed a macro-analysis approach utilizing a PESTEL analysis, which set the foundation for the rest of the project and allowed us to understand the forces shaping ABP Ireland's operations. Following this, we engaged in an internal audit through the use of SWOT and VRIO frameworks to effectuate our key macro-wide findings and apply them to the internal factors shaping ABP, identifying both opportunities and threats that would go on to drive our recommendations.

We then shifted from diagnostics to intervention by analysing ABP through Porter's Generic Strategies Framework. Through this framework, we came to a clear understanding that ABP pursues a distinct differentiation strategy focused on innovation, sustainability, high-quality products, and traceability. We identified a steadfast dedication to vertical integration within the firm, with ABP managing its own supply chain from livestock to logistics. An activity map was then created to allow us to turn complex information into actionable steps, facing the challenge of finding coherent strategies whilst choosing between many alternatives, with the diagnostic stage serving as a platform to create tangible strategic interventions.

In the evaluation stage, we were primarily focused on feasibility when considering possible strategic interventions, aiming to position ABP for long-term success within the beef industry. A roadmap for change spanning five years was decided upon as a group to compensate for both the potential unfeasibility of earlier time frames and unpredictable and unforeseen changes as a result of a longer period. We decided upon three pillars for our roadmap: sustainability, diversification, and integration, which sought to encourage uniqueness and allow ABP to become a pioneer both in sustainability and diversified product ranges.

The final compilation and reflection process involved synthesising all sections of the report into a coherent final evaluation. The consulting process was examined jointly by all members of the team to define exactly what had been gained from this consultant experience. Particularly, there was a focus on appreciating the real-life applicability of theory and previously studied frameworks such as PESTEL, VRIO, Porter's Generic Competitive Strategies, and others. Finally, this re-examination of our consulting process was performed to demonstrate the key lessons of this consulting experience, so as to benefit each team member in any future consulting-related endeavour.

Conclusion

This consultancy report provides a comprehensive analysis of ABP Ireland, examining how the company creates, captures, and sustains value within the agri-business sector. ABP's leadership in the agri-business sector is highlighted through its vertically integrated operations, strong sustainability practices, global export capabilities, and production of high-quality, grass-fed Irish beef. These strengths allow ABP to pursue a differentiation strategy that relies on delivering premium, ethically sourced products that meet the evolving needs and expectations of its consumers and regulatory requirements. However, we also saw that the company faces many challenges as outlined in the diagnostics section.

Our proposed interventions focus on three strategic pillars: Sustainability, Diversification, and Integration. These pillars were examined in depth in the intervention stage to reduce business risk, leverage competitive advantage, and optimise the firm's processes.

By implementing the five-year roadmap, ABP can leverage its core qualities and respond sustainably to market trends and maintain consistent, durable growth. Our recommendations throughout this report allow ABP to build a solid foundation for continued leadership, resilience, and competitive advantage in the changing agri-food industry.

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Appendix 1:

Team Reflection

Consultant	Assigned Stage	Individual Reflections
Megan Walker	Orientation Stage	Further developed my understanding of how to properly frame a consulting project and set the foundation for the rest of the stages.
Laura Pietrzak	Diagnostics Stage	Enjoyed conducting research and being able to apply tools such as the PESTEL framework to a real context, which helped us produce strategic findings that were genuinely actionable.
Sam Oates	Diagnostics + IntroductionStage	Had the opportunity to learn about ABP Ireland from a consulting perspective, a first for me. Applying in-class study frameworks such as the VRIO and SWOT analysis was really fulfilling and gave me a better understanding of how to approach the diagnostics stage of consulting.
Ross Sheridan	Intervention + Evaluation Stage	Enjoyed applying concepts learned in class to a real-world environment, brainstorming solutions with my team, and applying these and evaluating their impact.
Robert Mullins	Evaluation + Consulting Process Stage	Appreciated the challenge in gaining experience in turning insights into concrete actionable steps for future change, whilst considering feasibility and varying complex outside factors.
Emma Breton	Intervention Stage	Enjoyed the challenge of transforming complex strategic findings into realistic recommendations while still thinking about ABP's future direction

Appendix 2:

TEAM CONTRACT

Team Name _____ **Team #** INTB17

Team Members:
1) Megan Walker
2) Laura Pietrzak
3) Sam Oates
4) Ross Sheridan
5) Robert Mullins
6) Emma Breton

Team Procedures

1. Day, time, and place for regular **team meetings:**

Weekly, time variable depending on individual availability, Business School Cafe if in person, WhatsApp if online.

2. Preferred method of **communication** (e.g., e-mail, mobile, landline, Blackboard Discussion Board, Zoom (or other online platform), face-to-face) in order to inform each other of team meetings, announcements, updates, reminders, problems:

Whatsapp.

3. **Decision-making policy** (by consensus? by majority vote?):

Consensus, where possible. If not possible, a majority vote. If split 50-50, the team leader decides.

4. Method for setting and following meeting **agendas** (Who will set each agenda? When? How will team members be notified/reminded? Who will be responsible for the team following the agenda during a team meeting? What will be done to keep the team on track during a meeting?):

The team leader will set the agenda the day before the meeting, and members will be reminded through a message the morning of the meeting. The team leader will manage the agenda during the meeting, using the points mentioned in each agenda to stay on topic and relevant.

5. Method of record **keeping** (Who will be responsible for recording & disseminating minutes? How & when will the minutes be disseminated? Where will all agendas & minutes be kept?):

Individual members will note down elements of the meeting most essential to them, and general important points will be written by volunteer members during each meeting in the group chat. Minutes will remain available in the group chat.

Team Expectations

Work Quality

1. **Project standards** (What is a realistic level of quality for team presentations, collaborative writing, individual research, preparation of drafts, peer reviews, etc.?):

As high as feasibly possible, with both the presentation and report first draft completed, ideally, at a minimum, a week before necessary. Proofreading by individual members will then be carried out.

2. **Strategies** to fulfill these standards:

Ensuring that each element of the assignment is completed at least a week before is necessary to allow time for further editing, alongside having members read different sections of the report they did not directly contribute to and offering suggestions.

Team Participation

1. Strategies to ensure cooperation and equal distribution of tasks:

Volunteer system, with close attention paid to ensuring no member has too much/too little of a workload. Once writing has begun, this can be reviewed if needed.

2. Strategies for encouraging/including ideas from all team members (team maintenance):

Encouraging members who have been silent during a team meeting to contribute their thoughts, with regular reminders in the group chat that any ideas are welcome and appreciated.

3. Strategies for keeping on task (task maintenance):

Reminders throughout the week in the group chat to encourage members to engage with their tasks as soon as possible. A shared Google Docs file will also lay out the assigned tasks for each member.

4. Preferences for leadership (informal, formal, individual, shared):

Informal, most group members are well acquainted. In the unlikely event that issues arise, a more formal approach will be taken. Responsibility will be generally shared.

Personal Accountability

1. Expected individual attendance, punctuality, and participation at all team meetings:

Full attendance, proper punctuality and equal participation unless valid reason is given, with a team understanding that we all have varying schedules and that full attendance may not always be possible.

2. Expected level of responsibility for fulfilling team assignments, timelines, and deadlines:

Individual responsibility to fulfil tasks and deadlines, with an understanding that each member may have varying schedules and busy periods.

3. Expected level of communication with other team members:

Clear, regular communication - particularly regarding any potential delays, struggles, or issues to allow other members to assist as best they can.

4. Expected level of commitment to team decisions and tasks.

Full, equal commitment.

Consequences for Failing to Follow Procedures and Fulfill Expectations

1. Describe, as a group, how you would handle **infractions** of any of the obligations of this team contract:

As the group is well acquainted, informal suggestions and reminders of the necessity of working on this assignment are made.

2. Describe what your team will do **if the infractions continue:**

Continue reminders, if issues persist, a more direct request to work on the project. In the unlikely scenario that this continues, the issue can be raised with module coordinators.

****

a) I participated in formulating the standards, roles, and procedures as stated in this contract.
b) I understand that I am obligated to abide by these terms and conditions.
c) I understand that if I do not abide by these terms and conditions, I will suffer the consequences as stated in this contract.

1) *Megan Walker* date 15/10/25
2) Ross Sheridan date 15/10/25
3) *Laura Pietrzak* date 15/10/25
4) *Samuel Oates* date 15/10/25
5) *Robert Mullins* date 15/10/25
6) *Emma Breton* date 15/10/25